



Scientist Stephen Hawking has been hospitalised, but is said to be 'comfortable' after spending the night at the hospital

number has grown to 12,82,994 and we are sure this is just going to keep growing. Next up we have Oprah, who posted her first tweet on her show with the help of Twitter CEO Evan Williams. Oprah has just brought a whole new audience to Twitter and has almost 5,00,000 followers.

Twitter has also helped some people with their business, a recent example being that of Kogi (Korean BBQ) sold in Los Angeles on Taco trucks. Mike Prasad, brand ambassador for Kogi, wanted a single place where fans could meet. What better way to pass on this message to the world than with Twitter. You could even say thanks to these tweets the business is booming as they can talk directly to the customers using the 140-character tweets.

This is all about the present, but what does the future hold for Twitter? Well, one Adam Wilson has built a brain interface that allows users to post Twitter messages. For this to work, you will need to don a dorky looking cap which has electrodes attached to it so it can monitor your brain functions. This interface works by focussing on the alphabets being displayed on the screen. Once the desired character flashes, the cap can pick up the resulting impulse. The device still has its flaws as it can handle only about 10 characters per minute. With Twitter's

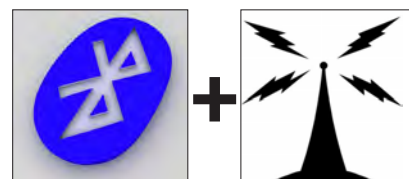


slums in the world, occupying about 175 hectares of land and has about a million people staying in it.

LIFE trust has created an 'English DVD' for this task and will be training teachers using portable DVD players. They have tried to make the learning process as interactive as possible with voice, video, quizzes, discussions and role plays so that the children get some quality education. If this new DVD system of education is successful at the Anganwadi level, it could revolutionise the entire public school education system.

Bluetooth 3.0

Up until now Bluetooth was used to transfer images and small audio or video files between cell phone users, it never reached the status of a great new wireless norm. But that's about to change as Bluetooth Special Interest Group (SIG) announced that the technology just got an overhaul and



You will clearly see that this has not been perfected yet as sometimes you might not get the image you are looking for and at other times your image search might not even have the similar image link. We tried this similar image search with the words 'smoke on the water' which gave image results of Deep Purple as well as actual smoke over the water, but only two similar image buttons were displayed on

they have released a new version named - Bluetooth 3.0 + High Speed (HS). This new version of Bluetooth boasts of transfer speeds of upto 24 Mbps which is due to the inclusion of 802.11 protocol, the same protocol used in WiFi.

The good news here is of course the increase of transfer speed, but the bad news is that your current mobile phones will not support this. Mobile phones with this v3 should start rolling out within a year. The computers that have the Bluetooth 2.1 + EDR module have a better chance as they can be upgraded to the new version.

The question of power consumption may also arise, this also is sort of a problem as larger the files transferred, more power will be consumed. The work around for this, the 802.11 protocol is triggered only during the transfer and not all the time.

This also means that the devices that use this new version will have to WiFi technology as well, so that they can take advantage of the increased data transfer speeds. But don't worry as this is also backward compatible and if paired with a device that does not have WiFi then it reverts to the old 2.1 + EDR module.

So what can this new Bluetooth 3.0 + HS accomplish other than what we have been using Bluetooth upto now for, well to start off, the range should be a definite increase, and in the near future you will also be able to stream camcorders to HDTVs or even PC to PMP.

character limit of 140, it would take you 14 minutes to create a maximum size message. Though this is still in a nascent stage, it is a great accomplishment in terms of neural interfaces.

Google similar images

Here's the latest tool from the labs at Google - search for similar images. With this option within the Google image search, users will get the chance to directly click on an image that might be similar to the one they are looking for instead of re-searching with different search criteria.

The similar image link is located below the thumbnail images which are displayed from your search. The technology that Google has used relies on metadata and image recognition based on content, perspective and colour, which helps users narrow their searches.

This search tool is currently available to try out at <http://similar-image.googlelabs.com>.

the page.

This will be a really helpful addition to Google's search engine and will save a lot of time for all of us.

Learn through DVD

Teachers from Dharavi in Mumbai will get to watch something other than *Slumdog Millionaire*, thanks to Landmark International Institute for Empowerment (LIFE) trust. The LIFE trust is going to be conducting a two-month program during which 25 Anganwadi teachers will learn English. Anganwadis are pre-school centres which have been established by the Central Government so that children up to the age of six can study. Anganwadis are a great initiative on their own, but now with LIFE trust giving another helping hand, language proficiency among the masses is set to improve. Most of these Anganwadis are located in Dharavi, one of the biggest